

TOML cheat sheet

Write predictable configuration, spot structural mistakes, and debug from the first failing line.

Syntax & types

Key/value `title = "HaveSome"`

Integer / float `count = 42` · `ratio = 1.5`

Boolean `enabled = true`

Inline table `point = { x = 1, y = 2 }`

Values are typed. Keys may be bare (port) or quoted ("display name").

Strings

Basic `path = "C:\\Users"`
processes escapes.

Literal `path = 'C:\Users'` keeps
backslashes.

Multiline `"""basic"""` or
`'''literal'''`.

Single-line literal strings cannot contain a quote;
multiline literals may contain one or two consecutive
quotes.

Collections & structure

```
ports = [8000, 8001]
[server]
host = "localhost"
server.tls.enabled = true
[[products]]
name = "Hammer"
```

Arrays preserve order and may mix value types.
[table] groups keys; dotted keys build nested
paths; [[array-of-tables]] appends records.

Dates & times

Local date `1979-05-27`

Local time `07:32:00`

Local date-time `1979-05-27T07:32:00`

Offset date-time `1979-05-27T07:32:00Z`

No quotes: quoted date-like text is a string. Z means
UTC; +02:00 carries an offset.

Common traps

- Keys must be unique in their scope.
- A scalar cannot later become a table.
- Strings need matching quotes.
- Booleans are lowercase.
- Array values need separating commas.
- Table headers change the scope of following keys.

Validate & debug

1. Start at the first parser error.
2. Check the key's current table scope.
3. Confirm quotes, brackets, and commas close.
4. Inspect the parsed path and value type.
5. Run `taplo check config.toml`.
6. Review the diff before staging.

TOML 1.1 references

[Language specification](#) · [toml-test corpus](#) · [Taplo validator](#)

HaveSome TOML teaches TOML 1.1. Validate against the version your toolchain supports.